Community letters

Here are just a few letters the Editor has recieved from you, the readers

Giveaway winners

Elfyn's recent beech bowl with unusual contrasting markings

Hello Mark,
Just a note to thank you very much for the Hamlet bowl gouge I received in the 'Giveaway' of *Woodturning* 285. It was a nice surprise and a very welcome addition to the armoury! I am a retired teacher and have only been turning a few years. I live near Pwllheli on the Llyn Peninsula in North Wales. I began by taking lessons from Albert Harrison in Holyhead, Anglesey. Unfortunately, clubs in this part of the world are few and far between and so I have to rely heavily on YouTube and books to further my progress, together with *Woodturning* magazine of course! It is frustrating that there aren't any woodturning exhibitions/demonstrations or shows in this area.

I have set up my workshop in the garage and use an Axminster AT1628VS lathe, which I find fits my needs very well. You are quite right when you say in the Leader of *Woodturning* 289 that practice is the all important element (along with sharp tools) in progressing and thus giving confidence.

I do sell some of my work, together with giving to family and friends, and recently enjoyed making a stool for my five-year-old granddaughter. I will continue to persevere with what I regard as a fascinating, satisfying, yet sometimes frustrating hobby.

We live in a world swamped with technology and I find it so refreshing to go back to nature and to feel the amazing characteristics of wood and its infinite uses, which I hope we won't lose sight of. Many thanks once again and keep up the good work.

Elfyn Hookes

Mark,
I went to pick up the post this morning and not only was there the latest issue of *Woodturning* magazine, there was also a strange, long package. I could not think that I had ordered anything, but a GMC label gave me a good idea.

Many thanks for the Hamlet bowl turning gouge that I won in one of the recent 'Giveaways'. My current favourite Henry Taylor gouge has only got about 50mm of flute left. I do have more than one gouge, so this will be ground to suit my needs. I will save it for the final cut!

I enjoy reading *Woodturning* and have subscribed for many years. I usually save magazines for years and I must confess that I recently took a large pile of old copies to be recycled (shame, boo, hiss). This was a way of spring cleaning and thinking about what my turning activity will be next year and it gave me a chance to look at the vast piles of rough turned blanks and wood that I have accumulated over the years. I have always been able to get hold of free wood and I seem to be unable to turn (no pun intended) it down when it becomes on offer. A new tool and a new year will get me into gear for the spring.

I really enjoy the production of turning, but selling the stuff made is a different story. I have done a local Christmas craft fair in Taunton for about 10 years and usually have a good weekend. 2014 was a disaster and I did not even cover the costs of the stall, so I decided to give 2015 a miss. What is the trick to getting rid of the stuff we make? I do think that the humble, plain wooden bowl has had its day, as homewares are going towards colour and metal. Maybe this is something that could be covered in a future *Woodturning* issue?

Jeremy Briggs

Hi Mark,
Thanks very much for the Henry Taylor bowl gouge, that arrived today. As I stated in my entry to the 'Giveaway' I will be donating the tool to Blackburn with Darwen Woodturning Club, of which I am a member. The club has 26 members and meets once a month.

Apart from the full club meeting, we also run a daytime 'class' every Wednesday. The club presently has eight lathes with equipment, all of which are Record lathes of various sizes and ages. Our Wednesday classes are open to beginners and more experienced turners. We usually have four to six more experienced turners attending to give tuition and help. Some of the participants have been attending classes since their inception approximately nine years ago, so as you can imagine they too are quite experienced turners but still attend for the company. The club doesn't normally supply tools, but recently we have had three new participants for the Wednesday classes and our experienced turners have had to loan tools for the sessions. The bowl gouge will come in very handy. I am also going to propose the club buys a set of spindle turning tools as finance allows.

Malcolm Brooks

Lyre clock

Dear Mark,
Here is a lyre clock I turned, inspired by John Austin in *Woodturning* 288. It is made of yew (*Taxus baccata*) with hornbeam (*Carpinus betulus*) scrolls. The turning was pretty straightforward, but I did have trouble gluing the clock dial in the dead centre of the two spirals. On reflection, it would have been better to have centred the clock first then match the spirals to the dial: as you know, with most things that are upright, getting them perfectly square is often the hardest part!

James Harris

James' lyre clock made from yew

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